

# 1. Man's Best Friend

"This is Sloane. Jonah is missing. He's been cooping himself up in his office for weeks but now, he's been gone for days. And he *never* skips work. I don't know where he is, Fanghe doesn't know where he is, *no one* knows where he is. Even Director Elliot has *called the police* to look for him, but they don't care about missing Radiators."

"I don't have a good feeling about this. You need to help us find him. Please."

**Series:** When the Wind Blows (1/5)

**Type:** Investigation, Roleplay, No Combat

**Mood:** Mystery, Point-and-Click, Tense

## Notes

- Time: 19:00-23:00, start with 15 minutes grace
- CW: Delta & Dragons
- Priority for @Archivists-of-the-Academic-Annals
- Catered to @Actor, @Instigator, @Storyteller
- **Very investigation heavy:** you'll need to be **active** in exploring places, talking to NPCs, and piecing clues together by yourself
- **This is a 2-party investigative session.** This is how it'll work:
  - All players need to uncover two things together: What happened to Jonah, and Where he is
  - Each party will see **two sides of the same story**. Each party will investigate different rooms. **You don't need to communicate between parties to solve your room**
  - However, knowing what's happening in the other room can enhance the session's story and your character's knowledge. For this, there'll be a thread for an IC group chat, a Google doc, or both
- React with :dog: if interested!

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## Session Opening

### Pre-session prep:

- Have the players divide themselves into 2 squads before the session opens: the Home investigators, and the Office investigators. These squads correspond to the two threads/investigations of this session.

- Have them decide on making an IC group chat, a Google doc, or both. Prepare these before the session starts.

**Ready question:** Why are you in this investigation? What do you think happened to Jonah?

## 15-minute ORP setup

The Players gather at the AAA's lobby to wait for Sloane and Chaarani. Sloane gives the party keys to Jonah's office. Chaarani gives the party Jonah's home address and a duplicate of Jonah's house key -- she convinced the police to give it to her in exchange for not exposing their incompetence.

Sloane tells the players she noticed he was missing in [6.39]. It has now been She reminds the Players of their two objectives to uncover:

- What happened to Jonah
- Where Jonah is now

Charani also tells the Players about the AAA' agreement with the police to let the AAA investigate:

"As you are Radiators well-trained in combat, the police are worried for public safety and property damage. We, at the AAA, would like to keep this to a minimal as well."

"Therefore, while in the AAA's premises, Jonah's home, and in public spaces, do not use pertatech gear and weapons. This is *imperative*. If you cause public harm or property damage, especially in investigating a missing person's case, the AAA will pay the price, and **you will be arrested.**"

**For this session, you cannot use powers and rituals for investigation. However, you may use things that grant rerolls, skill bonuses, etc. You may also use powers and rituals outside investigation. Avoid public harm and property damage at all costs.**

After answering questions, promptly divide the Players into two threads: the Home investigation, and the Office investigation. Sloane and Chaarani will not accompany them.

## Before we Begin

SKIP TO: [Jonah's Home](#) / [Jonah's Office](#)

## The Truth / The Timeline

### 5.29

Before "This is Not a Pipe", Jonah argues with Chaarani as he discovers Old World chimera and cyborg works aren't being displayed in AAA's exhibition. Chaarani shuts him down. This is not the first time she has on similar things. He's very upset.

### **5.32**

After "Now You See Me", Jonah promises Sunny everything will be all right. He begins investigating if there's anything suspicious about Chaarani, the AAA, or either's connections.

### **5.32-5.34**

After following the AAA's money, Jonah discovers shell companies have been donating superfluous amounts of money to the AAA. These shell companies were made by the government, despite the government already officially donating a smaller amount to the AAA monthly. He suspects corruption bigger than the AAA, but keeps investigating anyway.

### **5.34**

Worried his investigation can hurt people he cares about, and knowing what he has been doing is ethically wrong, Jonah lets himself go on a first but final date with Sunny in "without love, it cannot be seen".

### **5.36**

In "Moment of Decision", Jonah tells Sunny he can't continue whatever they have and stops it. Unable to sleep, he continues investigating AAA's donations at his office. Sloane catches him looking at accounting records in "First it Giveth".

### **6.37**

While preparing for Charlotte's funeral, Jonah receives his first threat: a nondescript box with the decapitated head of a golden retriever. It wears a muzzle and includes the message "GOOD BOYS DON'T BITE". Panicked, and not wanting to involve more people via exposure, Jonah seals the box back up and puts it on his shelf. The next day, he hears a faint, high-pitched whine in his office (it's a bugged microphone someone had planted in his work computer). He begins isolating himself in his office out of anxiety and paranoia.

### **6.38**

Sunny calls Jonah after Charlotte's funeral in "'Embers of the Heart'. He tries pushing her away, desperate for her safety. He fails: Sunny still pledges to wait for him until they can be together. He falls asleep in his office, where Fanghe finds him in "Fulfilling Responsibilities". She comments on his deteriorating state; he tells her to be careful. With heightened anxiety, Jonah changes the addresses of the AAA Radiators, Fanghe, and Sloane in AAA's records as a safety measure. Now that he's also free after his expedition, he dedicates his days to compiling compelling evidence.

Then, Jonah confronts Chaarani with all his evidence. He secretly records the entire conversation. Chaarani confirms that she has been following the government's secret requests to censor information and manipulate narratives for more funding. Even though this can be dystopic in the long-run, she's doing this out of desperation. The previous, corrupt director pocketed a significant amount of the AAA's funds. Now, the AAA barely has enough funds to sustain itself (its tightly-regulated archives are expensive) and is less trustworthy to donors. The AAA needs to make up the money they lost, or they'll go under in a few years.

Chaarani threatens Jonah to stop snooping around. He resorts to keeping all his collected evidence on his person and never parting with it.

### **6.39**

Jonah receives his second and final threat. He wakes up in the middle of the night to loud sounds from his garage. It has been broken into: his jeep's and motorbike's tires are slashed, and his personal expedition gear is destroyed. A note reads "CEASE OR YOU'RE NEXT". He shreds it apart.

In a full-blown panic, while still knowing that what he found must be exposed, Jonah checks for trains to Prospero. The next day, he gets a word lock. He also gets a mini safe box, puts all his evidence in it, and goes by train to Prospero. He rents a locker at the train station to store the safe box and keeps the locker key. He gets tools and cement to remove bricks in his house's foundation in the backyard. He puts the locker key inside, seals the hole with a brick, puts everything away in storage, and locks the door.

Jonah hides the storage door's key in a cabinet in his bathroom, which he secures with the word lock. He also marks the train station locker key's location on a weekly planner on his fridge. Then, he leaves a frenzied note about the bug he hears but can't find on his desk. Only then does he go to work at the AAA.

By the end of the work day, Jonah leaves the AAA to go home. At an empty neighbourhood street, an unmarked white van with no licence chases him down. Jonah sprints in the opposite direction, but one of the van's passengers pokes a gun out of the window, shoots Jonah, and stuns him. The passengers kidnap him into the van and drive away into the Hollow to throw Jonah out. This was all done by the government agents who threatened him.

### **6.40**

Fanghe begins searching for Jonah by putting up missing posters and talking to people. This leads her into talking to other people who has had their Radiator loved ones go missing as well.

### **6.42**

Inspired by the people she talked to and itching with rage to do something, Fanghe founds the Missing Radiator Society. The MRS declares itself to be an organisation to raise awareness about missing Radiators and the injustices surrounding it, a community for people to grieve and find hope, and a resource bank for what people can do to take action and to cope.

### **7.46**

The MRS collaborates with cyborg artist Caroline Gladkov to make a public art installation. On it, people may frame photographs of missing Radiators they know. The installation rapidly fills up with photographs. The government notices. They do not like it.

### **7.47**

Fanghe leads the MRS through a peaceful protest walk through Kingnexus. Fanghe grows

increasingly vocal about her cause. She ignores most of the negative backlash she or the MRS receive. This includes death threats made by government agents disguised as regular netizens.

## 7.48

The government decides to kidnap Fanghe to make a message. The Players are finally able to investigate Jonah's disappearance.

## Meta Notes

Each location has a pre-written description, which are bolded beneath the location names. You may use it for narration or make up your own.

Items that can be interacted with are written in capitals. This does not mean that capitalised items are needed to progress the investigation.

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### INVESTIGATION 1

## Jonah's Home

**is in a small suburban neighbourhood off the main road with lots of greenery. It's a 10-minute drive, or a 20-minute walk away from the AAA. He lives alone in a small, rustic 1-bedroom house. Inside, his house is decently neat. The whole house is washed in earthy, neutral tones. Its simple furnishings and its frequent use of wood gives a cosy, homey feel.**

All physical locks in this house can be pick-locked with THIEVERY DC MED. However, due to the fragility of these common locks, they will be broken afterwards.

## The Living Room

**is where you first step in. By the door is a shoe rack. Arranged tastefully in front of you is a COUCH with a throw and pillows, a dark COFFEE TABLE, a BOOKSHELF, and a TV on a TV STAND.**

**To the left are two doors: one white, one dark-brown. To the right, besides the TV, is a door that leads to the GARAGE. Beyond the living room is a DINING TABLE, which sits in the KITCHEN.**

The TV STAND is locked. The key to open it is in the GUEST BATHROOM. Inside is a small TOOLBOX. It contains unused needles and syringes, alcohol prep pads, bandages, and an old, folded piece of paper. The paper list instructions on how to perform a self-injection. Next to it is a SHARPS CONTAINER to dispose used needles and syringes.

A thin PHOTO ALBUM contains a few photographs of someone who looks like Jonah's younger sister. Every picture is of her and a changing group of friends as the years pass. NATURE/PERCEPTION DC EASY reveals that though the photographs aren't dated, they don't look old. They all look like they're printed around the same time.

There is also a BROCHURE for Five Flags, an amusement park located in Prospero. This brochure advertises the opening of the park's sunflower field. This is Jonah's clue for the Players to go to Prospero.

The white door is for [The Storage Room](#). Hanging by its knob on a string is a disc clip with a muddy, well-used disc attached to it. It's locked. Its key can be found in [The Bathroom](#).

The dark-brown door leads to [The Bedroom](#).

## The Kitchen

is clean, except for a bowl of rotting bananas sitting on the COUNTERTOP. Above and below the counters are CABINETS. There's also a DINING TABLE for four, the STOVE AND OVEN, the SINK, and the FRIDGE that has things stuck on it.

To the left are two doors. Ahead is a door that leads to the BACKYARD.

There's nothing remarkable about the kitchen. Everything is kept neat and clean and shows the sign of a well-used kitchen. Besides the rotting bananas on the COUNTERTOP, there are also cutting boards, a small set of kitchen knives, a microwave, a toaster, and an air fryer. There's also a big box of jasmine rice. Placemats for dishes are set in the centre of the DINING TABLE. Cloths and oven mittens hang from the OVEN's handle, beneath the STOVE. The SINK is mostly clean except for some scraps in the drain.

The CABINETS contain dishes, bowls, cups, and utensils -- more than a single person needs. One yellow cup reads "PROSPERO UNIVERSITY". There are also pots, pans, and a lot of spices and condiments. Most of them are bought in Prospero. There's one cabinet that's filled with medicine, supplements, and protein powder. At the front is also a bottle of melatonin.

What's noteworthy is what's stuck on the FRIDGE's door. Besides a schedule for when trash is picked up, there's also a WHITEBOARD pinned to the fridge by the magnets behind it. It's a 2x10 grid that makes up a weekly schedule. A yellow magnet is stuck on the third day of the week. The grid corresponds to the exposed brick foundation in [The Backyard](#). Inside the fridge are wilted produce and old takeout food.

The first door that's closer to the living room is [The Laundry Room](#). The second, further door is [The Guest Bathroom](#).

## The Laundry Room

is simple. There's a **WASHING MACHINE** and a **DRYER**. Folded up against the wall is an **IRONING BOARD** and **CLOTHES RACK**. There's a metal **SHELF** for storing detergents, cleaning chemicals, and the like. A vacuum cleaner is tucked away here, too. There's also a basket of tennis balls.

The **DRYER** has two more tennis balls in it. Insert dog joke here. (It's to prevent clumping on bulky items and to make things fluffier.)

## **The Guest Bathroom**

is simple: there's a toilet, a bin, toilet paper, a sink, and a mirror. The mirror acts as the door for a mounted **SHELF**.

The **MIRROR SHELF** contains spare toilet rolls, hand soap, and the **TV STAND** key in [The Living Room](#).

## **The Storage Room**

has a single light switch that illuminates the tiny space in harsh, white light. All tossed into here messily are folded boxes, luggage, camping gear, and -- on top of it all -- a stack of small cones used on sports fields, a netted bag full of more discs of different designs, and a gym bag.

There is also a **BRICK HAMMER**.

It looks brand new.

But its sharp end is used.

A single **BRICK** lies next to it.

The sharp end of the **BRICK HAMMER** was used to remove a brick in the house's foundation from [The Backyard](#). With **DUNGEONING DC MED**, the dust and streaks on it indicate that it was used against something like mortar or cement. The **BRICK** confirms this: it is covered in some mortar.

## **The Bedroom**

is modest, with not a lot of personal decoration. The **BED** is made of a mattress sitting atop a dark bed frame. It's unmade. Next to you, against the wall, is a wooden **DESK** and a cushioned chair.

To the left is a door. To the right is another door.

Jonah's bedroom reflects his state of mind. His **BED** is unmade, its blanket crumpled and its pillows tossed about. On his **DESK** is a lamp, a **LAPTOP**, and a **NOTEPAD**. The first page is scrawled in pen:

*MY OFFICE ISN'T SAFE*

*I CAN HEAR THEM BUT I CAN'T SEE THEM*

This is in reference to the microphone bug in [Jonah's Office](#), in his computer. He could hear its high-pitched whine, but he wasn't able to find the source.

Jonah's personal LAPTOP is locked. ARCANA/STREETWISE DC MED can crack it. It opens to a website for New Victorville's public train system, to a page that displays train schedules to Prospero. This is another one of Jonah's clues to the players to go to Prospero (even if it's unintentional); specifically, to go to Prospero's train station.

The door on the left leads to [The Walk-in Closet](#). The door on the right leads to [The Bathroom](#).

## The Walk-in Closet

**has HANGERS lining the top of the walls, SHELVES stacked along the middle of the walls, and a mix of SHOE RACKS and BOXES on the floor, beneath the shelves. An ironing board and iron are tucked away in a gap.**

The HANGERS are mostly filled with trousers, dress shirts, sweaters, and light coats ranging from rugged leather to classy trench coats. One sweater reads "PROSPERO UNIVERSITY GRANDPA". Some hats are also hung here: large-brimmed fedoras for the sun, furry trapper-hats for the cold. There are only three sets of three-piece suits. However, PERCEPTION/STREETWISE DC MED reveals that each of them are of very high quality -- likely custom tailored.

The SHOE RACKS display a minimal amount yet wide range of utilitarian footwear: mountain boots, formal loafers, soccer cleats, casual sneakers, and beach sandals. Other miscellaneous things like socks, towels, bedsheets, blankets, undergarments, and belts are stored in BOXES. However, tucked away in a dark corner behind the boxes is a simple mech suit. It's more of an exoskeleton than a suit: it's like Fanghe's morph suit, but much simpler. It can't be used now; it's out of power.

The SHELVES store stacks of folded everyday clothes. What catches the Player's eye is a bright yellow shirt at the top of a stack. It's a sports jersey. On the front is a graphic of an Old World dog mascot with the text "PROSPERO SHEPHERDS". One sleeve features the logo of Prospero University; the other features the dog mascot. At the back is "VANDERMEER" with the number 96 beneath it.

Jonah got this jersey when he was in Prospero University's ultimate frisbee varsity team. It's also Jonah's clue for the word lock in [The Bathroom](#); its key is "SHEP". An AAA Radiator who passes HISTORY DC MED learns a bonus fun fact. One would know Jonah is of Chinese-Indonesian descent. "9" is "jiǔ" in Mandarin Chinese; "6" is "enam" in Indonesian and is sometimes shortened to "nam". Put together, "jiǔ nam" sounds like "Jonah" or "Djoena".



# The Bathroom

has a toilet, a sink, a mirror, a bin, and a shower with a seat. To the right is a CABINET. On top of it are some sprays and gels for sore muscles and sports injuries. Hooked onto its doors is a word lock.

The key for the word lock is "SHEP". The sports-related ointments on the CABINET is a clue that the key is related to the sport Jonah plays: ultimate frisbee. Inside the CABINET is the key to [The Storage Room](#).

# The Garage

is dark. Even forms are vague for those who can see in low light. There's the shadow of a JEEP with a MOTORBIKE squeezed next to it. To the back of the garage is a pile of GEAR. To the front, near the garage DOOR, are two BINS.

Surely there is a light switch somewhere.

The Players can find it:

There is one near the door. You turn it on.

You see ruin.

The wheels of the JEEP and the MOTORBIKE have been slashed. The well-used, heavy-duty, expensive expedition GEAR have been knocked out of shelves and lie wrecked on the ground.

It must've taken a very big blade and a very strong person to cut through those jeep tires.

At least with the light, you can see the garage DOOR and the BINS' contents better.

Upon closer inspection, the JEEP and MOTORBIKE are in even worse shape. Both of their side mirrors are broken and have been snapped off. There are some tears in its seat. The JEEP's windshield is cracked. The garage DOOR is in bad shape too, even if it doesn't look like it: ARCANA MED DC reveals that its digital lock has been tampered with.

There's one smaller green BIN for organic trash. Next to it are two big, tall BINS are for garbage and recycling. The garbage bin has nothing but tied-up trash bags. However, the RECYCLING BIN has pieces of crumpled, torn-up PAPER. The Players can put it together and read the typed message on it:

*CEASE OR YOU'RE NEXT*

This note and property damage were done by government agents. This was Jonah's second and final threat to stay silent.

# The Backyard

has grown wild in the years its caretaker has been missing. There's a small GARDEN bustling with ripening spices and vegetables. A small SHED has its door left open: gardening tools can be seen inside. But the most eye-catching of them all is what grows against the house's wall: a small field of SUNFLOWERS growing tall and wild towards the sun.

Jonah, who grew up on a farm, has taken up his parents' green thumbs. He uses the onions, garlic, chilli peppers, tomatoes, potatoes, and bok choy he grows in his GARDEN to cook. Some weeds have begun to emerge around them.

Passing NATURE DC MED tells a Player that based on the SUNFLOWERS' height and maturity, they were planted roughly half a year ago. However, passing NATURE DC HARD narrows the timeframe down to [5.31]. After Sunny embroidered a sunflower on his handkerchief, Jonah absent-minded decided to plant sunflowers that same week. These flowers will also act as a hint of what's to come.

NATURE/PERCEPTION DC MED reveals that, based on how some stems are bent and snapped, someone had walked through the sunflowers towards the house's wall. While inspecting this, a Player will also notice the house's exposed brick foundation. This corresponds with the whiteboard schedule in [The Kitchen](#)'s fridge: Jonah removed a brick whose location corresponds with the schedule's yellow magnet. The BRICK HAMMER from [The Storage Room](#) and an ATHLETICS check can remove the marked brick. Passing DC EASY removes it while damaging the sunflowers; passing DC MED removes it without any damage. Failing does nothing and damages the sunflowers.

Behind the marked brick is an empty hole. There, a simple BLACK KEY connected to an elastic wristband sits there. It's labelled with "9". This is the key for a LOCKER in [Prospero Train Station](#).

## What Players Should Learn

When the entire house has been searched, the Players should know to go to Prospero Train Station. They likely have to search the entire house to both come to this conclusion and to obtain the BLACK KEY.

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## Prospero Train Station

has a Western, rustic feel to it. From where you arrive, you can see the station's ENTRANCE AND EXIT, the TICKET BOOTH, multiple TRAIN TRACKS, and a wall of numbered LOCKERS.

The BLACK KEY unlocks LOCKER 9. The first thing the Players see is Jonah's sunflower-embroidered handkerchief neatly folded inside. Atop it is a hastily written note:

*My promise to you.*

Behind it is a mini SAFE BOX. It has alphanumeric buttons: each button has a number and some letters. Its key should be 4 digits long. It's "4278", aka "HARU".

Inside is a stack of items. On the top is a pocket VOICE RECORDER. It has one audio recording that's dated [6.38]. It sounds slightly muffled, as if it was covered by fabric. However, a conversation can still be heard...

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**There's rustling as papers are placed on a surface, stack after stack.**

*Jonah's tone is firm.*

J: "I have the evidence."

J: "Every, single, donation to the AAA since you became director. Government donations are circled in red."

J: "Private company donations are highlighted: the ones from Green Thumbs Accounting, Sawyer & Co., Young Blood Records, Millet Agriculture, and Black Cross Ltd."

**The final stack of paper hits the surface. There's a short pause.**

C: "How thorough of you."

**A light thump on the papers.**

J: "As I'm sure you're aware, the government makes its monthly donations. In the month you came into office, these private companies began donating monthly as well."

C: "I have been working to attract more donors, yes."

J: "Yes, and I am also aware about how all these donations are staggered through the month. But--"

**Papers are sifted through and laid out. Jonah speaks at the same time.**

J: "--all five of these companies, one from each zone, are shell companies. There's no real information on who they are, or what kind of work they do. There's even no *\*evidence\** of any real work they do. There's nothing -- absolutely *\*nothing\**. But they share one thing in common."

## **A hard thump against a surface.**

J: "They are all owned by the same politician who's currently part of our government. A politician who's known to have \*anti-Radiator sentiments\*."

C: "That is an interesting connection you have drawn."

J: "Don't talk to me like I was born yesterday, Chaarani. Individually, the shell companies donate less than the government. But if you add them all together, since they're from the same politician? That's just over \*twice\* the amount the government donates."

C: "Are you accusing me of corruption?"

J: "It speaks volumes that you think I'm accusing you. I could've simply been stating my concern about shady donations."

## **Silence.**

C: "Spit it out, Jonah. What are you trying to say?"

## **Silence, again.**

J: "The government, or at least some part of it, is paying the AAA to censor information -- to manipulate the narrative our relics tell."

J: "The government wants the public to forget about the discrimination against Radiators in the past -- why else would Davu Kask need to break into a private, secured database to retrieve discriminatory propaganda?"

J: "And while the public's forgetting about what happened in the past, the government -- \*and\* the AAA -- begin to use those exact same discriminatory tactics from the past."

J: "Take the chimera and cyborg relics from CalArts I recovered, for example. There's also Ms. Gladkov's exhibition, and how she was chosen to begin with."

J: "You're also doing \*nothing\* to get Sloane off the bench, even though she has proven her worth for twice the years I've been here for. In fact, you demoted her from being a handler for the Radiators!"

C: "I demoted her due to negligence of her work."

J: "That must've been a nice excuse, huh?"

C: "I ask you to watch your \*tone\*, Jonah. Remember who you're speaking to."

J: "I know who I'm speaking to. I'm speaking to the AAA's director who's supposed to be uplifting our name after how the previous director pocketed all

our donations. You're not supposed to be dragging our name, our history, through the mud—"

C: "—Would you rather have the AAA go under in a few years?!"

C: "Do you think I *\*want\** to do this, Jonah?"

J: "No, but I thought you knew better than to do this. Chaarani, you're a *\*linguist\**. You *\*know\** how words alone can shift the way people think, let alone *\*historical documents!\**"

J: "You know how history works, too. Whoever controls information and education controls the people. This has happened in history over and over and over again. If you let the government keep its fingers on the AAA, know how *\*dystopic\** this can be!"

C: "What am I supposed to do instead?! Dissolve a century's worth of history and relics? Deprive the public of a wealth of knowledge?"

C: "*\*We need money,\** Jonah. Even if we have less than a hundred employees, it is still *\*expensive\** to maintain the AAA and to preserve all the relics we have."

J: "There are better ways—"

C: "There are *\*less sustainable\** ways. What will you even do with all this, Jonah? And what will you do afterwards? Are you going to submit that to the police who work for the government? Are you going to make everyone here lose their jobs?"

J: "No, just yours and the politician's, unless you change how the AAA is run. I'll find a way."

C: "No, you WON'T."

*Her voice darkens.*

C: "*\*Drop it\*,* Jonah. Keep sticking your nose into places it shouldn't be in, and trouble *\*will\** find you."

**Silence.**

J: "Is that a threat?"

C: "No. I am trying to *\*protect\** you. You will *\*not\** speak to this to anyone. You will *\*not\** pursue this investigation. I am not *\*paying you\** to do that."

**The papers are hastily gathered, neatened against a surface, and shoved away.**

C: "You are *\*dismissed.\**"

Papers and fabric rustle over footsteps. A heavy door opens and closes. The footsteps quicken. There's a loud rustle and suddenly, Jonah's quick and heavy breaths are audible. When he speaks, his voice is loud, clear, and rushed.

J: "This is Djoena Vandermeer, aka Jonah. I was speaking with Chaarani Elliot. The date is [6.38]."

CLICK

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Below the voice recorder is a thick FOLDER. Each and every incriminating document mentioned in the recording is in that folder, accompanied by typed commentary and more supporting evidence. The meticulous amount of details presented must've taken weeks -- no, *months*, especially for someone with no accounting background.

There is a final piece of paper beneath the folder. There are only two words written on it with a pen:

| *I'm sorry.*

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INVESTIGATION 2

## Jonah's Office

smells of stale air. A thin layer of dust has touched every corner of this abandoned room. Not even the faint smell of coffee beans can convince you that this room was once alive.

On the left wall are SHELVES filled with boxes. To the right, ahead of you, is Jonah's DESK. Against the farthest wall of the office is a PANTRY set up on the tops of cabinets. Though there are none in this office, there are multiple SECURITY CAMERAS throughout the AAA.

This is what most of you first notice upon entering. But for chimeras and cyborgs with sharper hearing than commons, what first gets your attention is ||a faint, high-pitch whining through the room||.

To detect where the whining is coming from, a Player who is able to hear it needs to make a PERCEPTION DC HARD check. They'll realise it's coming from [The Bug](#) inside Jonah's computer

## The Desk

The main point of interest is Jonah's work computer. ARCANA/STREETWISE DC MED can hack into it. It's very mundane at first glance. However, a Player can more thoroughly backtrack Jonah's activity with another ARCANA/STREETWISE DC MED check.

This reveals two things. First: Jonah has recently been looking through the AAA's database of employees. Specifically, he modified entries on these employees:

- "Arlecchino" Zhakarov, Félicette
- Chaarani-Bai, Fanghe
- Choi, Sunny
- Croix, Sloane Mallory
- Hiroshi, Toval
- Liyanasurya, Ayumu

AAA Radiators will recognise that their home addresses in the AAA's database has been changed. Due to his home being broken into, Jonah is paranoid that the same will happen to people in the AAA he's closest to. Changing their addresses was an optimistic, yet fruitless, attempt at security -- unfortunately, the government still has everyone's correct addresses on their own database.

The second revelation is that Jonah has been looking through the AAA's financial records. However, there's nothing to indicate why he was: all his investigative work has been deleted from this computer, and he didn't modify any of the records.

A player who reads through the records may make a PERCEPTION DC MED check. They'll notice that monthly donations are made by the government and by five companies:

- Green Thumbs Accounting, from Archivale
- Sawyer & Co., from Kingnexus
- Young Blood Records, from Neonspire
- Millet Agriculture, from Prospero
- Black Cross Ltd., from Dynazenon

A STREETWISE DC HARD check reveals that, though disguised well, all five companies are shell companies. The Players can't uncover more than that, such as who truly owns the companies -- they do not have enough time to do that right now.

## The Bug

To remove the bug from Jonah's computer, a Player needs to make a ARCANA/THIEVERY check. Passing DC EASY removes the bug but breaks the computer; passing DC MED removes the bug without damage. Failing does nothing unless it's a NAT 1 -- it'll break the computer, too.

The bug is a microphone bug: it records audio and transmits it somewhere. It's very small, and therefore very easy to break.

## The Desk Drawers

This is the second point of interest of Jonah's desk. The topmost drawer is unlocked. Inside are stationary: ballpoint pens, fountain pens, dip pens, bottles of ink, pencils, erasers, rulers and a cloth. There's also a folded piece of paper with a doodle of a sunflower in it.

The second drawer is locked. A PERCEPTION check has to be made in [The Pantry](#) to find the key. Inside is a bunch of miscellaneous office and archaeological supplies. But, shoved between them all is a notepad where Jonah has written the names of the five shell companies.

## The Pantry

Jonah likes having guests in his big office, and he likes treating them to foods and drinks. Therefore, he has transformed the top of these cabinets into a pantry. There are dishes, cutleries, a small cutting board, mugs, and glasses on one end. There's also a kettle and very well-maintained coffee machine -- the expensive kind that grinds beans. There are some bags of coffee beans. A mini fridge also sits here. There are cartons of processed fruit juices and sweet tea inside.

Thoroughly searching this area calls for PERCEPTION DC MED. On a success, the Players can find a key in one of the coffee bags. This key is for [The Desk Drawers](#).

## The Shelf

Boxes and boxes of relics are stored here for Jonah to catalogue, study, and/or restore. They're large in size and contain either equally large relics, or a collection of smaller relics of the same type.

PERCEPTION DC MED spots two boxes that stand out. One is a smaller, silver gift box. Its navy blue bow is pinned by a pin in the shape of a sun. Inside, wrapped in paper, is a navy blue purse with an Old World impressionistic painting of sunflowers on it.

The other box is not as pleasant. It is an ordinary, plain cardboard box sealed shut with messy loops of tape. There's no smell coming from it. But, inside is a decapitated golden retriever head wearing a muzzle. A typed note inside the box reads:

*GOOD BOYS DON'T BITE*

This note and box was sent anonymously; there are no indicators of who sent it. Government agents were the ones behind this -- this is their first warning to Jonah to stop his investigation and to stay quiet. The dog-pertavore was not chosen because Jonah is a



dog-chimera -- in the government's database, Jonah is legally Common. It's meant to represent his loyalty to the AAA and, by extension, to Chaarani and the government.

The reason Jonah didn't throw the box out was because he was afraid of involving more people into his investigation and consequences via exposure. In his rushing, panicked mind, the best he could come up with was to seal the box back up, stuff it deep into his shelf, and try to forget that it was ever there.

## The AAA's Security Cameras

If the Players ask, Chaaran will let them view all of the AAA's security footage. They won't be able to find who brought the box with the decapitated pertavore. But, on [6.39], they can see Jonah coming in for work extremely late. He's agitated enough for his emotion to be caught on low-resolution footage. However, he leaves home at the same time. This is the same day Jonah compiles all his evidence to stash in Prospero Train Station.

The Players can look through public Archivale security cameras. However, whether they want to do that by hacking or by talking to the police, they'll have to be in close proximity to or inside the Archivale Police Station.

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## Archivale Police Station

Whether through DIPLOMACY, INTIMIDATION, or ARCANA DC HARD, Players can find a way to view Archivale's security cameras. If the Players make compelling arguments while trying to persuade police officers, whether that be through being convincing or by abusing PRECISION status, the DC can be lowered to MED.

If successful, the Players can track Jonah's movements during [6.39] in [The Truth / The Timeline](#), **only up until the van leaves Archivale**. The security footage does not extend beyond Archivale; the Players do not see the van enter the Hollow through Prospero. The Players also can't tell if the van returns to Archivale. They only know that no white vans without license plates re-enter Archivale.

However, after the kidnapping, a white van with a license plate does eventually park in front of Green Thumbs Accounting's office.

## Green Thumbs Accounting / Chasing Fanghe

The office building is a very small and largely unused two-story building. The van is no longer parked at the front. The Players have two choices of getting into the office:

- Lockpicking the door with THIEVERY DC MED twice: to pick the lock, and then to lock it back up. Rolling a NAT 1 breaks the lock.

- Looking for another entry with PERCEPTION DC MED. There's a window left open on the second floor: if Players have the right tools, they can roll ACROBATICS/ATHLETICS DC MED to scale the wall and climb through the window.

Inside, the office is incredibly barren. No one is inside. There are simply four desks with computers. Hacking into one with ARCANA/STREETWISE DC HARD reveals that they've broken into a government-owned computer. They'll find the government's watch list. These are the last two entries on the list:

- Vandermeer, Jonah. Status: ELIMINATED, [6.39]
- Chaarani-Bai, Fanghe. Status: IN PROGRESS, [7.48]

Jonah was targeted due to Chaarani. She was aware of his investigation and asked the government to scare him into stopping. When they failed twice, they decided to eliminate the problem altogether by kidnapping Jonah.

However, Chaarani is fully unaware that her own daughter is their next target. Fanghe has put herself in the government's crosshairs by founding the Missing Radiator Society and creating a lot more noise than the government likes.

Currently, Fanghe is performing at Red Sun Underground: she will not respond to messages or calls until the end of the session. The government agents are also waiting in their white van at Fanghe's residence, to kidnap her as soon as she gets home. Whether through searching the government database or by Ayumu, the Players can get to the government agents before Fanghe gets home.

## The Government Agents

These agents work directly under a politician Ayumu recognises. This politician was once Ayumu's father's comrade. However, the politician backstabbed Ayumu's father to get ahead. If INTIMIDATION checks are good enough, the government agents will reveal their intents as written above.

However, they will **not** confirm nor deny if they have Fanghe kidnapped or not. They are specially trained to deceive, intimidate, and mess with people's heads. The most useful information they'll reveal, however, is where they took Jonah: the Hollow. Exiting from Prospero, they drove Northwest in a straight line for 40 minutes, tossed Jonah out of the van while bound with a bag over his head.

After interrogating the government agents, Fanghe finishes her show and is able to respond to texts and calls. She has no idea of what was going to happen to her. The Players are also welcome to try drive out into the Hollow themselves.

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# The Hollow

As it is Hexune, it is incredibly cold, and the atmosphere is beginning to crystallise. The drive is tedious, and it's not guaranteed that the Players will even be able to find any trace of Jonah with all this snow, ice, hail, and wind.

Fortunately, they do on a successful PERCEPTION DC HARD check. Just a couple hundred metres off the original path, they can find a pair of zip-ties and a black bag frozen into the ground. Jonah has freed himself. They also don't find any scraps of clothing or any blood, meaning that he wasn't attacked -- in this area, at least.

The Players are unable to search further: they'll need proper gear and a proper plan for that. There's nothing left to do here except to turn back and return home.